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Part One: Reading Passage

Instruction: Read the text below and answer the questions following it.

Decision-Making Skills

1. The capacity to select a sound option from two or more alternatives is a key component of decision-making abilities. There are three primary methods to view decision-making as a form of problem-solving talent. Intuition, or the gut sensation you have when faced with a situation or a choice to make, is the first way. Intuition might be **arbitrary** because it is based on your personal experiences. Contrarily, the reasoning is grounded in facts. This is a more impartial method of decision-making, and it is typically how major choices are reached. Decisions are typically made using both intuition and reasoning. An excellent technique to ensure that your decision is **logical** is to use **both**. We naturally mix the two instead. Although other skills are often used, intuition and reasoning account for the majority of decisions. If you are skilled at making judgments, you are likely also good at a variety of other abilities needed to make a **sane** decision. To make a successful decision, one must use logic, process information, use intuition, ask questions, consider possible outcomes, and more.
2. Effective decision-makers approach decision-making through multi-step processes. You must first recognize the choice you must make and comprehend the factors that will influence that choice. Second, you need background knowledge to make the best selection for each situation. This can sometimes be as simple as recalling specifics from conversations or it can involve conducting more in-depth research. Then you want to think creatively or want to think of as many solutions as possible. It doesn't matter if they're good or bad, you just want to consider all of your options. When this happens, you should be innovative or try to come up with as many alternatives as you can. No matter how favorable **they** may be, you should still weigh all of your options. The next step is to evaluate your options. Now is the time to double-check all of your possible outcomes. Selecting one of your ideas comes next to evaluation. Keep in mind that to make the greatest selection possible, you can select a solution you came up with or even combine options. The sixth crucial step is to put your decision into practice. You must begin taking the steps necessary to put your decision into action as soon as you have made a decision. Finally, when your decision is made and you've had some time to see its effects, take a second to evaluate that decision. It's a **fabulous idea** to use this time to reflect on your decision-making to improve yourself as well as your decision-making skills.
3. Being able to make smart decisions needs a variety of other crucial talents, which makes it such a vital skill. Let's look at some other abilities you can develop to aid in your decision-making. Problem-solving is the most important talent you need to have in order to make good decisions. Having the ability to solve problems effectively is a plus because decisions are just problems of choosing the optimal course of action. Sometimes more than one individual must make a decision. When a group is involved, you occasionally require strong teamwork and **compromise** abilities to come to the optimal option. Understanding your own emotions as well as the

emotions of those around you is known as emotional intelligence. You will be able to make better decisions if you can consider your emotions. In addition to these, to make a wise choice, you must be able to weigh the pros and cons of many factors and your feelings. Your decisions will be stronger if you can properly review and understand the information, possibilities, and alternatives.

4. To improve your decision-making skills, you need to use the following tips. Having your eye on the big picture is enormously helpful when it comes to decision-making. Someone can make all the right decisions, but if their ultimate goal is wrongheaded, then those great decisions don't add up to anything useful. It's easier to know how to reach a destination if you have a clear idea of what that destination is. Reduce choice. Being inundated with too many potential choices can paralyze you. Before you begin making decisions, try to narrow down your possible choices to the top three. Good decisions are predicated on good data, so start working to improve your research skills. The greater your knowledge and expertise, the simpler most decisions become. Communication skills complement decision-making skills well. Whether you're seeking out advice or expressing a project's goals, team members who understand each other get more done, more effectively.

I. Based on the information in the text above write True or False for each of the following statements below in the space provided (1 point each).

- ____ 1. Problem-solving and making good decisions are two parallel actions.
____ 2. When you are exposed to many options, you may become stuck.
____ 3. Often important decisions are made using intuition because it is a more objective process.
____ 4. Intuition and logic are responsible for the bulk of judgments; no other abilities are required.
____ 5. Teamwork or group decision-making is time taking and dragging to arrive at the best solution.

II. Choose the best answer to the following questions from the given alternatives and write the letters of your choice in the space provided (1 point each).

- ____ 6. Effective decision-makers do not employ one of the following steps when making decisions.
A. think creatively
B. select an option
C. consider alternatives
D. All
- ____ 7. One of the following tips is necessary to enhance your decision-making abilities:
A. maximize your range of options
B. set unrealistic objectives
C. communication skills
D. All

8. One of the following tips is not a skill that contributes to making our decision stronger.

- A. problem-solving
- B. collaboration

- C. emotional intelligence
- D. background knowledge

9. The contextual meaning of the word "arbitrary" (paragraph 1, line 4) is ____

- A. subjective
- B. random

- C. rational
- D. predictable

10. The meaning of the phrase "sane decision" (paragraph 1, line 10) is ____

- A. sensible choice
- B. informed decision

- C. sound decision
- D. all

11. The phrase "fabulous idea" (paragraph 2, line 15) means ____

- A. bad idea
- B. great idea

- C. wrongheaded solution
- D. A and C are answers

12. In line 6 of paragraph 3, the term "compromise" has one of the following meanings:

- A. collaborate
- B. negotiate

- C. promise
- D. bargain

III. According to the passage, what do the following words refer to (1 pt. each)

13. The word "both" (paragraph 1, line 8) refers to ____

14. The pronoun "this" (paragraph 2, line 4) refers to ____

15. The pronoun "they" (paragraph 2, line 8) refers to ____

16. The pronoun "it" (paragraph 3, line 1) refers to ____

Part Two: Words from the Textbook (module)

The words below are taken directly from your textbook. Choose the word that completes each sentence and write it in the space provided (1 pt. each).

innumerable

ravage

self-esteem

abundant

pursue

kinship

1. People with low _____ tend to feel less sure of their abilities and may doubt their decision-making process.
2. Ethiopia is a country with _____ natural resources, yet its political instability doesn't allow the people to use them properly.
3. The wildfire _____ large areas of forests in Europe last month.
4. The project has been delayed due to _____ problems.

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